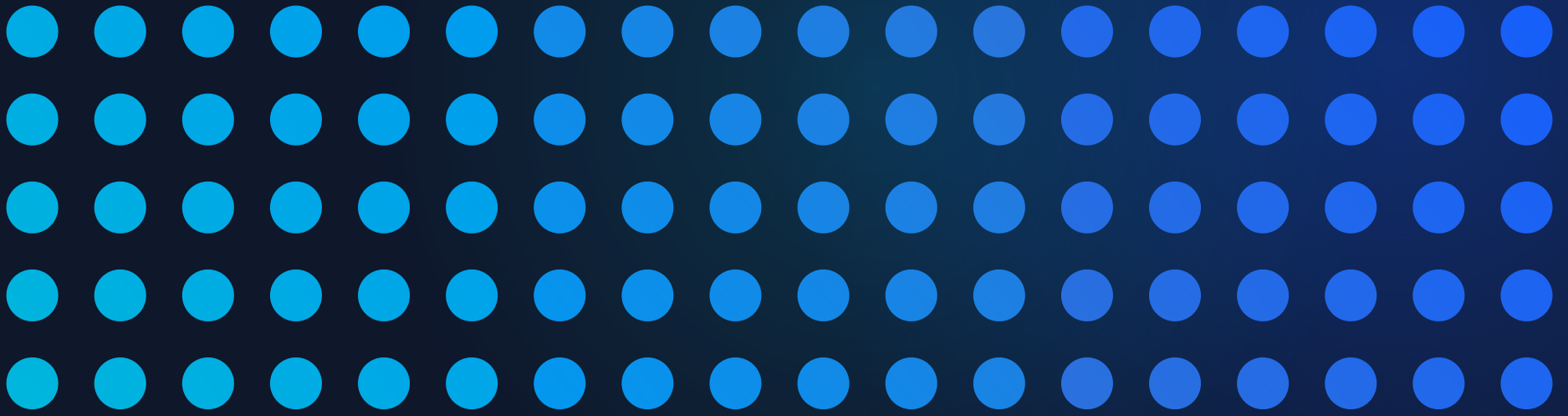
TRANSPUTEC

90 DAYS · 90 DOTS



The Resilience Playbook.

Ninety days to a calmer, safer IT estate. Six plays, each with the questions to ask out loud.

HOW TO USE THIS PLAYBOOK

Built to be spoken, not just read.

01

Read the play

Each play is one page. It opens with the evidence, so you can say why it matters in a sentence.

02

Ask out loud

The questions are written to be spoken in a meeting. Use them as written. The silence after is useful.

03

Agree an owner

Every play ends with a test: what is true when it is done. Name one person and one date.

EVIDENCE BASE

1 DSIT and Home Office, Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26

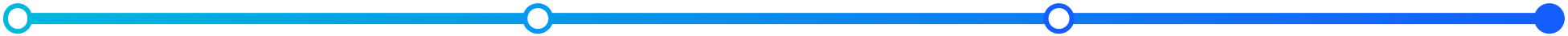
2 IBM, Cost of a Data Breach Report 2025, UK edition

3 NCSC, Annual Review 2025

4 Cyber Monitoring Centre, JLR assessment, October 2025

THE 90 DAYS AT A GLANCE

Three months. Three verbs.



DAYS 1-30

See

Know what you run and who can get in.

- 01 · Map what matters
- 02 · Close the front door

DAYS 31-60

Rehearse

Practise recovery. Set rules for AI.

- 03 · Rehearse recovery
- 04 · Govern AI use

DAYS 61-90

Prove

Extend to suppliers. Report in numbers.

- 05 · Know your suppliers
- 06 · Brief the board

KNOW WHO YOU ARE TALKING TO

Three leaders. Three different first questions.

MANAGING DIRECTOR

Continuity and reputation

Wants a plain answer and a number for the board.

OPEN WITH

"If our systems stopped on Monday, what would we have lost by Friday?"

IT DIRECTOR

Capacity and noise

Wants fewer alerts, fewer vendors, and cover at 3am.

OPEN WITH

"What did your team not get to last quarter?"

FINANCE DIRECTOR

Cost and predictability

Wants a fixed fee and no surprises in the budget.

OPEN WITH

"What did unplanned IT cost us last year?"

PHASE 01 · DAYS 1-30

See.

Know what you run, and who can get in.



PLAYS IN THIS PHASE

02 · Map what matters

03 · Close the front door

PLAY 01

Map what matters

1 list

The first deliverable is a single page: the systems, data and logins the business cannot run a day without.

WHY IT MATTERS

You cannot protect, monitor or restore what has not been listed. Most recovery plans fail on the first question: which system comes back first, and who decides?

ASK OUT LOUD

"Which five systems would stop us trading if they went down?"

"Who can sign in to each one, and when did we last check?"

"Where does our most sensitive data actually live?"

DO

- ◯ List the five to ten systems and data sets the business depends on.
- ◯ Name a business owner and a technical owner for each.
- ◯ Record where each one is hosted and who supports it.
- ◯ Mark which suppliers or outside logins touch them.
- ◯ Agree the order of recovery with the leadership team.

DONE WHEN — One page exists, every item has two named owners, and the leadership team has agreed the order of recovery.

PLAY 02

Close the front door

38%

of UK businesses faced at least one phishing attack last year, the most common type and the one most often named as the most disruptive.[1]

WHY IT MATTERS

Phishing was the most common attack in the government survey, and compromised credentials were the third most common cause of UK breaches in IBM's data.[1] [2] Sign-in is where most incidents begin.

ASK OUT LOUD

"Is every account protected by more than a password, starting with email?"

"Do admins use a separate account for admin work?"

"If someone clicks a bad link today, who finds out, and how fast?"

DO

- ◯ Switch on multi-factor sign-in for every account. Begin with email and administrators.
- ◯ Separate admin accounts from everyday accounts.
- ◯ Add a one-click "report phishing" button for staff.
- ◯ Run a short monthly note on one real example, not an annual course.
- ◯ Set devices to update automatically and check the exceptions.

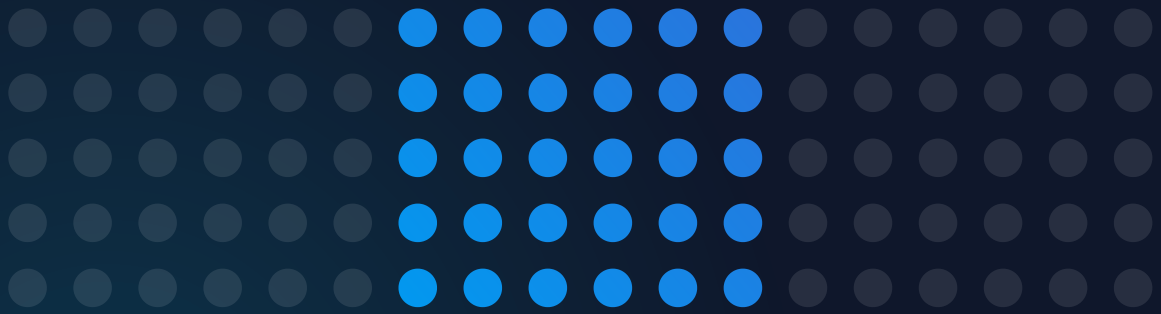
DONE WHEN — Every account uses multi-factor sign-in, admin accounts are separate, and a reported email reaches IT within a minute.

Sources: [1] DSIT, Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26. [2] IBM, Cost of a Data Breach 2025, UK edition.

PHASE 02 · DAYS 31–60

Rehearse.

Practise recovery. Set rules for the AI already in use.



PLAYS IN THIS PHASE

03 · Rehearse recovery

04 · Govern AI use

PLAY 03

Rehearse recovery

25%

of businesses have a formal incident response plan. The rest will write one during the incident.[1]

WHY IT MATTERS

UK organisations that used security automation extensively found a breach in 148 days and contained it in 42. Those that did not took 168 and 64.[2] Practice shortens both numbers.

ASK OUT LOUD

"When did we last restore from backup, onto a different machine?"

"At 2am on a Sunday, who decides, and who rings the customers?"

"How long can we be without each of our five systems?"

DO

- ◯ Write a one-page plan: who decides, who calls, who tells staff and customers.
- ◯ Restore one real system from backup and time it.
- ◯ Run a 90-minute tabletop exercise with the leadership team.
- ◯ Agree a target recovery time for each of the five systems.
- ◯ Store the plan somewhere you can reach without your own network.

DONE WHEN — The plan has been exercised once, a restore has been timed, and recovery targets are written next to each system.

Sources: [1] DSIT, Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26. [2] IBM, Cost of a Data Breach 2025, UK edition.

PLAY 04

Govern AI use

£498k

extra breach cost paid by UK organisations with high levels of unsanctioned AI use.[2]

WHY IT MATTERS

Only 31% of UK organisations have policies to govern AI use, and 63% have no access controls for AI systems.[2] Staff are not waiting for the policy. They are already pasting work into tools.

ASK OUT LOUD

"Which AI tools is the business already using, officially or not?"

"What is the one kind of data nobody may put into them?"

"Who owns this decision?"

DO

- [ ] Ask each team which AI tools they use. Do not make it an interrogation.
- [ ] Publish a short approved list and a plain red-line list.
- [ ] Put access controls on the approved tools.
- [ ] Name one owner, with the authority to say no.
- [ ] Review the list every quarter.

DONE WHEN — An approved list is published, one person owns it, and staff can say in a sentence what they must never paste in.

Source: [2] IBM, Cost of a Data Breach 2025, UK edition. Shadow AI: unregulated, unauthorised use of AI.

PHASE 03 · DAYS 61–90

Prove.

Reach your suppliers. Report in numbers.



PLAYS IN THIS PHASE

05 · Know your suppliers

06 · Brief the board

PLAY 05

Know your suppliers

15%

of businesses review the risks posed by their immediate suppliers.[1] Supplier compromise was the top UK breach cause at 18%.[2]

WHY IT MATTERS

Your resilience is only as good as the least-prepared company with access to your systems or your data. The incidents that make the news usually arrive this way.[3] [4]

ASK OUT LOUD

"Which ten suppliers could stop us trading, or see our data?"

"How quickly must they tell us about an incident, in writing?"

"What is our plan if one of them is down for a week?"

DO

- ◯ List the ten suppliers you depend on most and rank by dependency.
- ◯ Ask each the same five questions: certifications, notification time, data location, access to you, exit plan.
- ◯ Tier them: critical, important, routine.
- ◯ Add incident notification terms at the next renewal.
- ◯ Review the critical tier every year.

DONE WHEN — Ten suppliers are ranked, the critical ones have answered in writing, and each has a stated notification time.

Sources: [1] DSIT 2025/26. [2] IBM 2025, UK. [3] NCSC Annual Review 2025. [4] Cyber Monitoring Centre, JLR assessment.

PLAY 06

Brief the board in numbers

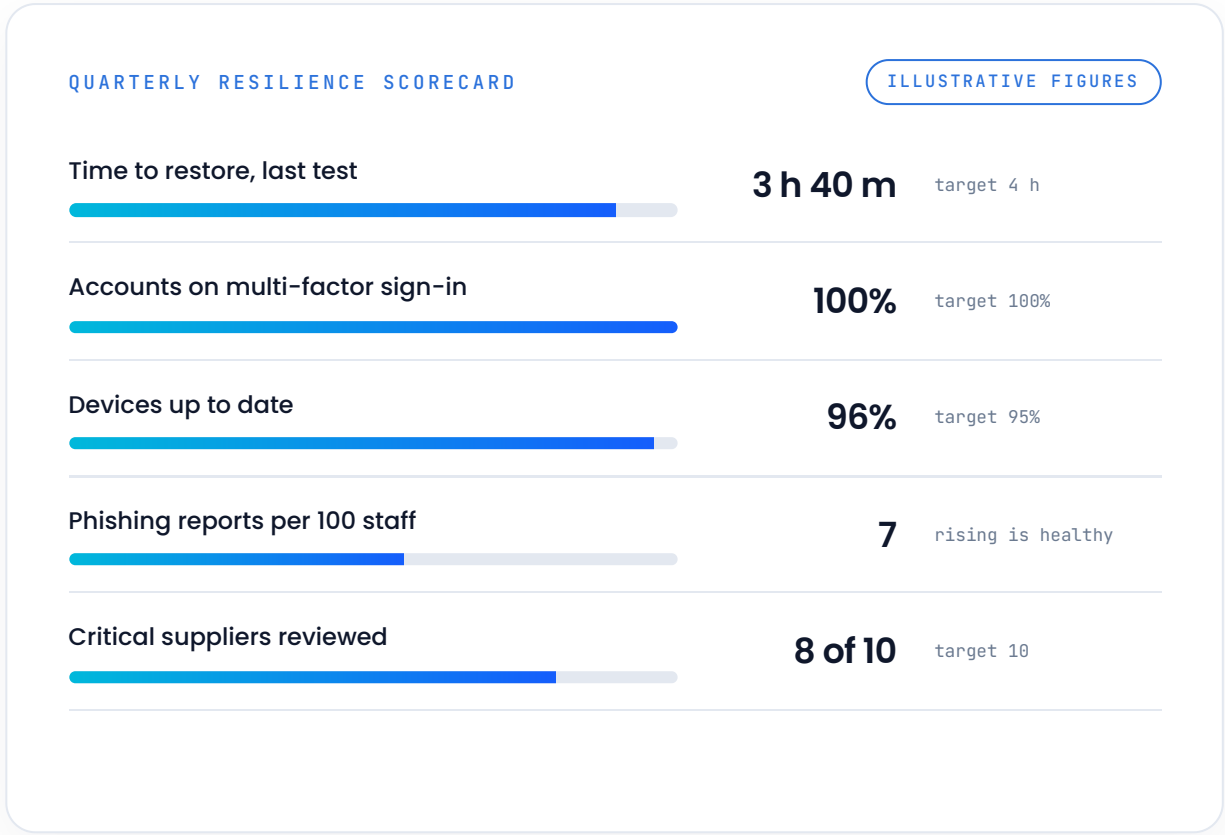
5

numbers on one page, every quarter. Same five, same order, so the trend is the story.

ASK OUT LOUD

"What is the one number that would tell us we are getting safer?"

"Are we reporting activity, or outcomes?"



DONE WHEN — The board has seen the scorecard twice and can say whether each number is moving the right way.

THE CONVERSATION CHEAT-SHEET

Four things you will hear. What to say back.

"We are too small to be a target."	Four in ten micro businesses reported a breach or attack last year: 42%. Size changes the odds, not the exposure.[1]	Ask: "What would a week offline cost us?"
"We already have backups."	Good. Backups are the start of recovery, not the end of it. The question is whether anyone has restored from them under pressure.	Ask: "When did we last restore one, and how long did it take?"
"IT looks after all of that."	Only 25% of businesses have a formal incident plan.[1] If it is not written down, it lives in one person's head.	Ask: "If they were on leave, who would decide?"
"We cannot afford it right now."	UK breaches cost £3.78m on average without extensive security automation, and £3.11m with it.[2] The cheap work is rehearsal and ownership.	Ask: "Which of the six plays costs only time?"

Sources: [1] DSIT, Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26. [2] IBM, Cost of a Data Breach 2025, UK edition.

TRANSPUTEC

NEXT STEP

Your ninety days start with one conversation.

Predictable IT. Predictable budget. Contracted outcomes.
Talk to a London-based partner about the first play.

Book a strategic consultation →